Guy-Arnold Djolaud

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Languages: English (Fluent), French (Native)
Citizenship: Côte d'Ivoire

Profile

PhD candidate in Economics at McGill University (thesis submitted; degree expected December 2026), working at the intersection of labour economics and macroeconomics. My research combines Canadian administrative microdata with structural macroeconomic models to study labour market power, the distributional effects of macroeconomic shocks, and the monetary and fiscal policy responses designed to mitigate them. Extensive experience with confidential Statistics Canada microdata. Fully bilingual in French and English.

Fields

Primary: Labour Economics
Secondary: Macroeconomics (monetary and fiscal policy)

Education

- **McGill University** — Montreal, QC, Canada
  PhD in Economics (thesis submitted; degree expected December 2026) — *2018 – 2026*
  - *Thesis: Three Essays in Labour and Macroeconomics. Supervisor: Fabian Lange; co-supervisor: Markus Poschke.*

- **Université de Montréal** — Montreal, QC, Canada
  M.Sc. in Economics — *2016 – 2018*
  - *Thesis on Bayesian state-space estimation of macroeconomic latent states. Supervised by William McCausland and Immo Schott.*

Research

- **Labour Market Power in Canada: Long-Term Trends and Cyclical Dynamics** — *Job Market Paper* [Paper]
  This paper provides the first time-series analysis of labour market concentration in Canada. National concentration gradually declined from 2001 to 2019, while local concentration rose temporarily by 14% during the Great Recession. The long-run decline reflects two offsetting forces: increased within-industry competition and wage-bill shifts toward more concentrated sectors. During the Great Recession, 68% of the increase in local concentration was due to sectoral reallocation. A calibrated TANK model with employer market power shows that fiscal expansions compress wage markdowns, boost the labour share, and markedly reduce consumption and income inequality between workers and capitalists.

- **The Insurance Value of Monetary Union: Sovereign Debt and Reserve Pooling** [Paper]
  Pooling foreign-exchange reserves can insure members of a currency union against the monetary consequences of national sovereign-debt distress, even when it does not prevent default. Monthly

IMF central-bank accounts for the eight WAEMU members (2007–2026) show low comovement of national foreign claims and a regional coverage ratio about half as volatile as national ones. In a quantitative model of a member economy with long-duration defaultable debt under a fixed parity, pooled backing lowers the mean quarterly devaluation probability from 1.60 to 0.29 per cent and sharply weakens the pass-through of national reserve losses to common coverage and the policy rate, while raising equilibrium borrowing (external debt of 53.5 versus 45.7 per cent of GDP) and default frequency: insurance against devaluation is not insurance against default.

- **Phillips Curve Flattening Mechanically Weakens NAIRU Identification** — *Submitted* [Paper]
  In the standard random-walk state-space model, the likelihood information about an interior NAIRU state relative to the smoothness precision supplied by the state equation is proportional to the squared Phillips curve slope. Canadian quarterly data from 1977 to 2026 show the mechanism is quantitatively severe: across the February 1991 inflation-targeting break this ratio falls by a factor of twenty-three, driven almost entirely by the slope. The credible interval for the unemployment gap then contains zero in 97 per cent of quarters, against 73 per cent before, and without a sign restriction the posterior probability of a negative slope falls from 0.99 to 0.78.

- **When Tariffs Meet Oil: Optimal Monetary Policy with Household Debt** [Paper] [Slides]
  How should a commodity exporter set monetary policy when foreign tariffs and oil prices rise together, and who bears the adjustment? In a small open economy with nominal household debt, housing collateral and gradual mortgage repricing, calibrated to Canadian data, a CPI rule raises the policy rate and borrowers absorb most of the contraction. The Ramsey allocation instead cuts the rate, roughly halves the output decline, and keeps borrower consumption at its no-shock level, at the cost of higher consumer price inflation; the policy choice is mainly redistributive.

Working Papers

- **The Trajectory of Immigrants' Exposure to Labour Market Power in Canada** (with Y. Diallo) — *CLEF Working Paper, Canadian Labour Economics Forum* [Paper]
  Using tax administrative data, we show that immigrants initially enter labour markets with higher concentrations of foreign-born workers, and that this concentration gradually declines as they integrate into more competitive and diverse employment environments.

- **Immigration, Labour Dynamics, and Fiscal Sustainability** (with F. Diabagate) [Paper]

Applied Policy Work

- **Country Climate and Development Report – Côte d'Ivoire** (World Bank, 2023), co-authored pages 209–216. Climate finance diagnostics, fiscal policy modelling and green growth scenario analysis. [PDF]

Professional Experience

- **Climate Economics Consultant — World Bank Group** Montreal, QC, Canada
  Country Climate and Development Reports (CCDRs) *Feb 2023 – Jun 2024*
  - Conducted climate finance diagnostics and contributed to macro-fiscal policy modelling and green growth scenario analysis for a published country report.

Teaching Experience

- **Teaching Assistant: Microeconomic Theory** — Montreal, QC, Canada
  McGill University — *January 2025 – April 2025*
- **Teaching Assistant: Macroeconomic Policy** — Montreal, QC, Canada
  McGill University — *September 2018 – April 2020*
- **Teaching Assistant: International Trade** — Montreal, QC, Canada
  McGill University — *Winter 2018*
- **Teaching Assistant: Principles of Economics, Microeconomics** — Montreal, QC, Canada
  Université de Montréal — *September 2016 – April 2020*

Conferences and Seminars

- CEA Annual Conference, Montreal – May 2025
- Emerging Excellence Conference (CIQSS), Montreal – May 2025
- Institutions and Regional Development Conference, Naples – Sep 2024
- World Bank Group Africa Chief Economist Seminar – Jun 2024
- CIREQ Conference, McGill – 2023, 2024
- Labour Group Seminar, McGill – 2024
- Applied Breakfast Seminar Series, McGill – 2022–2024
- GREDI/CREATE/CIREQ PhD Workshop, Sherbrooke – Sep 2019

Skills

- **Methods:** Bayesian estimation and MCMC (Gibbs sampling, state-space methods), DSGE/TANK models, time-series and panel econometrics, administrative microdata
- **Software:** Stata, R, Python, MATLAB, Dynare, E-Views, SPAD, LaTeX
- **Languages:** French (Native), English (Fluent)

Fellowships and Awards

- **2024** Great Travel Award
- **2023** Statistics Canada CIQSS Award
- **September 2021** McCall MacBain Award, McGill University
- **March 2021** Max Stern Award, McGill University
- **2021** Professor Fabian Lange Graduate Award
- **2020–2021** Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada
- **2020–2021** Fonds de recherche du Québec – Société et culture (FRQSC)
- **January 2020–Summer 2021** Tuition Fee-Waiver Award, Government of Côte d'Ivoire
- **2018–2023** PhD Fellowship, McGill University
- **2018** Award, International Affairs, Université de Montréal
- **2018** Bernard Landry Award, Université de Montréal
- **2016–2018** Tuition Fee-Waiver Scholarship, School of Graduate Studies, Université de Montréal

References

Fabian Lange (Supervisor)
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Markus Poschke (Co-supervisor)
Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
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McGill University
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Security Clearances

Statistics Canada